

Dollar for the Arts

A fundraising front-end for Arterial's fall campaign — turning the content and tools we already own into **many small, defensible donations.**

Arterial.org · 501(c)(3)

Fall fundraising campaign

For discussion with Scott

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The context

THE MOMENT

Arterial wants a **fall fundraising campaign** with a purpose-built, conversion-ready anchor — and to run **Facebook / Instagram ads** that are defensible for a non-profit: they drive *voluntary donations*, not payment for access.

THE ORG

Arterial.org — the registered 501(c)(3) — with **Not Real Art** and **Artsville USA** as programs, plus a library of podcasts and lead magnets already in hand.

Neighbours in the inbox: #008 Paywall (why *not* to wall readers out) · #009 Owned Platform (where content could live) · #013 Impact Report (retains the donors this acquires).

THE REFRAME

We're not starting from zero

NOT THE PROBLEM

"We have *no* lead magnet."

We have **several** — proven ebooks, podcasts, an email audience, donation rails, ad accounts.

THE REAL QUESTION

What do we **already own** that makes fundraising this way possible **without reinventing the wheel** — and what's the one missing piece that turns it into donations?

The missing piece isn't content. It's a **campaign-ready front-end** that converts *bought* traffic into *broad small-dollar giving*.

What we already own

Proven lead magnets

NRA ebooks — *Bomb The Art World*, *100 Top Street Artists* — plus the Freebies library, the Grant, the Conference. Already do email capture.

Donately

Owned donation rails — embeddable **one-time + recurring** widgets. Ugly pages, strong widgets.

Instapage (Optimize)

Ads-first page builder — A/B, dynamic text, ad→page mapping, custom subdomain. **Free to us at our tier.**

Facebook audience

Scott's live ads should be building lookalike + retargeting audiences on the NRA pixel. *Warm traffic. (verify)*

Content + audio

Not Real Art podcast library, Artsville programming, Arterial Radio, the #013 impact report.

Email channel

Curated.co — the existing NRA newsletter audience for follow-up + re-engagement.

AN HONEST TAKE

Arterial Radio

WHAT IT IS TODAY

A collection of sequenced podcast episodes — no dedicated listening app. You subscribe, or play it on a website. Not truly mobile: no easy gym, car, or on-the-go listening. Online radio gets little listening now; consumption has moved to on-demand podcasts, which we already have, free.

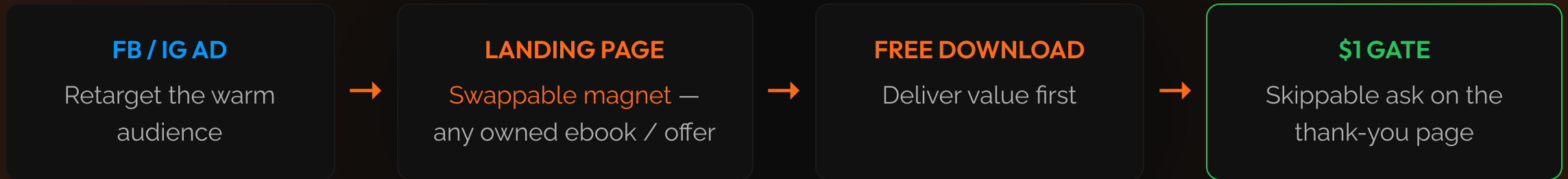
WHERE IT GETS INTERESTING

The gap isn't the *content* — it's *delivery*. An installable app gives the audio a portable, anywhere listening experience it doesn't have. *"Donate a dollar, install the Arterial app, take it with you"* makes the app itself the magnet.

The SiriusXM ambition for Arterial Radio is a separate, bigger conversation — out of scope here.

THE CONCEPT

An ads-first landing system



One funnel, many magnets. The "\$1 for the arts" onboarding stays constant; the magnet behind it swaps per campaign — so we A/B which offer converts and reuse the same donation flow everywhere.

We already run this pattern — minus the ask. The magnets already capture email; today's thank-you page is dead space. Skippers roll into a follow-up email drip until they give.

How strong is the gate?

SKIPPABLE-BUT-STRONG · RECOMMENDED

The ask is prominent and persuasive, but the download is still free if they decline. The donation stays a **clean voluntary gift** — which the defensibility argument depends on.

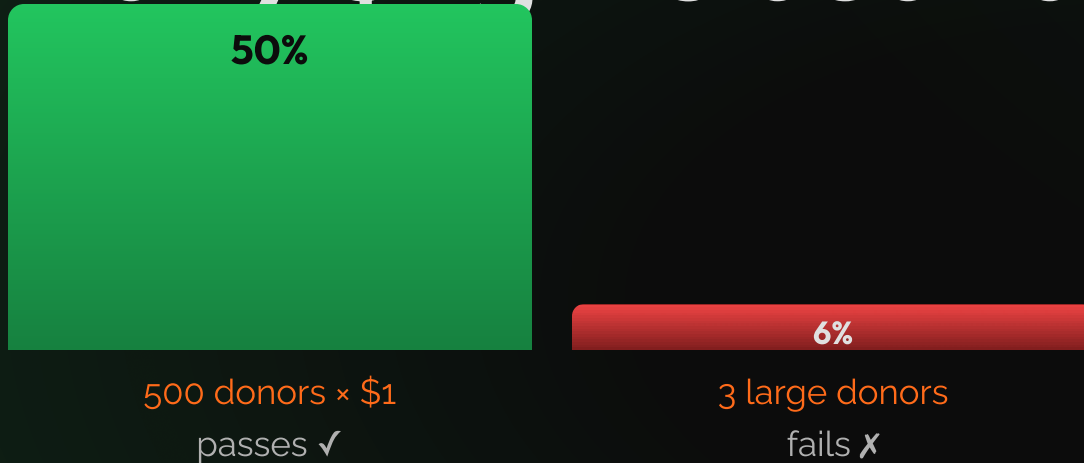
HARD GATE · CAUTION

"Donate to download" turns the magnet into a **purchase** — quid-pro-quo territory. It looks like paid access, weakens the "contribution," and invites the objection #008 raised against walls.

► How hard the gate can be *while keeping the dollar a deductible gift* is a question for nonprofit counsel / CPA — not a design preference. Default: skippable-but-strong.

WHY THIS IS DEFENSIBLE

Many \$1 gifts beat a few big ones



Public-support ratio on the same \$1M raised. Dashed line = 33⅓% pass threshold.

The IRS caps any single private donor at 2% of total support — so breadth, not dollars, protects public-charity status. Founder self-funding actually *hurts* the ratio. A low-friction \$1 ask is the most efficient breadth engine there is — and a voluntary gift avoids the quid-pro-quo of paid access.

Source: Arterial 501(c)(3) public-support research — [research file](#) →

NEAR-ZERO NET-NEW BUILD

The stack we already own

Instapage (Optimize)

Refactor magnet pages to be fundraising-first + campaign-matched. A/B + dynamic text + ad→page mapping included. Publish to give.arterial.org (subdomain, auto-SSL). *Don't upgrade to Convert.*

Donately widget

Embed the one-time / recurring \$1 widget on the thank-you page. Track the gift via the Meta pixel + redirect (embeds don't hit Instapage's native goals).

Ads + hosting

Retarget the warm FB audience for a better cost-per-donation. Everything lives on arterial.org — the registered 501(c)(3) — for donor trust and receipt clarity.

Full platform analysis + sources: research/instapage-fundraising-research.md →

DELIVERY MODEL — AN OPEN DECISION

Web app now, native later?

Factor	Web PWA	Native iOS
Payment cut	0% via Apple Pay	0% via Apple Pay (not IAP) — a wash
Ad-funnel friction	Ad → one tap into onboarding ✓	Ad → App Store → install → open ✗
Build & maintenance	One codebase, ships in weeks ✓	Swift/RN, review cycles, iOS-only ✗
Time-to-launch (fall)	Weeks ✓	+ review + platform time ✗
Best at	Acquisition — cheap \$1 gifts, fast	Retention — background audio, push, habit

Lean: web-first for the fall campaign; native iOS as a phase-2 option if the goal becomes a retained listening product. ► **Apple Pay / no-IAP claims to confirm vs App Review Guidelines §3.2.1.**

A WAY TO SEQUENCE IT

A phased approach

PHASE 0 · THIS FALL

Web only. Refactored Instapage magnet pages on give.arterial.org + Donately \$1 gate + follow-up drip, driven by [retargeted FB/IG ads](#). Reuses what's live.

PHASE 1 · IF IT CONVERTS

An installable [PWA](#) bundling podcasts + freebies + radio — the [app itself becomes the magnet](#): portable, anywhere listening.

PHASE 2 · LATER

A [native iOS app](#) if the listening product proves out — decided against real Phase-1 numbers, not up front.

THE ASK

What we need to decide

OPEN QUESTIONS

- Gate hardness — skippable vs hard → *counsel's call*
- Which magnet leads the fall campaign
- Verify the FB pixel / warm audience is building
- App as magnet, or web content first?
- Reuse vs rebuild existing content

IF WE GREEN-LIGHT PHASE 0

- Confirm the lead-magnet + which leads
- Legal review of gate + receipt language
- Stand up give.arterial.org + pixel
- Refactor pages, embed Donately, wire the drip
- Build a click-through prototype

Use what we own. Ask for a dollar. Build the **breadth** that keeps Arterial a public charity.

Sources & References

Evidence behind the claims in this deck

500 donors × \$1 → ~50% public-support ratio (passes); 3 large donors → ~6% (fails); founder-funding hurts — IRS §170(b)(1)(A)(vi) 2% cap; IRS Schedule A instructions, Foundation Group, Public Counsel. Compiled in Arterial's [501\(c\)\(3\) public-support research](#).

Instapage Optimize includes A/B + dynamic text; AdMap ad→page mapping; custom subdomain via CNAME; native Meta pixel — Instapage docs + independent pricing reviews, as of 2026-07-11. [Instapage research](#).

Donately embed works but completions don't register in Instapage's native conversion tracking — Instapage + Donately embedding docs, 2026-07-11.

Donation-page best practices (single CTA, message match, \$1→\$5→\$25 ladder, mobile-first, 501(c)(3) trust signals) — Fundraise Up, iDonate, DonorPerfect, RallyUp, 2026-07-11.

Existing NRA magnets — [Bomb The Art World](#), 100 Top Street Artists (live, 2026-07-11).

Apple Pay 0% for nonprofits / no IAP for donations — UNVERIFIED; confirm vs Apple App Review Guidelines §3.2.1.

Full URLs, quotes, and retrieval dates: [ideas/014-dollar-for-the-arts/research/](#) — [sources.md](#) indexes every claim.